

Topic 11: SEO Writing with AI

11.1 AI and SEO Strategy

- AI can generate SEO-optimised content but must be guided by your own keyword research and strategy
- AI does not know your current rankings, search volume data, or competitors' content -- you provide the strategy
- Use AI for: drafting articles, writing meta descriptions and title tags, generating FAQs, and creating content briefs
- Google's guidance (helpful content update): original, expert, people-first content ranks; thin AI content does not
- Best approach: AI-assisted content that includes genuine expert insight, original data, and a unique angle

11.2 Keyword Integration

- Provide target keywords in your prompt: 'Write a 1,000-word article targeting the keyword [keyword]'
- Natural integration: 'Use [keyword] 3--5 times naturally, including in the first paragraph and one subheading'
- Semantic terms: 'Include these related terms naturally throughout: [list of LSI or supporting keywords]'
- Avoid keyword stuffing: review AI output to confirm keywords read naturally, not forced
- Keyword research tools to use before prompting AI: Google Keyword Planner (free), Ahrefs, Semrush, Ubersuggest

11.3 Meta Descriptions and Title Tags

- Title tag: 'Write 5 SEO title tags for a page about [topic], include [keyword], keep each under 60 characters'
- Meta description: 'Write 3 meta descriptions, include [keyword], keep each under 155 characters, end with a clear CTA'
- Schema markup: 'Write FAQ schema JSON-LD for these 5 questions and answers: [list them]'
- Open Graph tags: 'Write og:title and og:description for this article: [paste title and summary]'
- Check rendered length: use Google's SERP snippet preview tools to confirm tags are not truncated

11.4 Content Briefs and Topic Clusters

- Content brief: 'Create a brief for a pillar page on [keyword]: target audience, search intent, outline, suggested word count, internal link targets'
 - Topic cluster: 'Suggest 10 supporting articles for a pillar page on [main topic], each targeting a different long-tail keyword'
 - Gap analysis: 'The top 3 ranking articles on [keyword] cover [brief summary]. What angles or subtopics are they missing?'
 - FAQ section: 'Generate 10 questions readers commonly ask about [topic] that I should answer within this article'
 - People Also Ask: check Google's 'People also ask' box for [keyword] to supplement AI-generated question lists with real search data
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